

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ K J 8 4

♣ A 5 3

♠ A 9 8 6 2

♥ K J 10 7 2

♦ 6

♣ 4 2



♠ Q 7

♥ 9 5 4

♦ 10 9 5 2

♣ J 10 9 7

♠ K 5

♥ Q 8 6

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ K Q 8 6

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass     | 2♥    | Pass | 2♠    |
| Pass     | 3♥    | Pass | 4♥    |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♥ by North

West trump play was good defense; it has prevented you from ruffing 2 ♠s in dummy. Even so your best plan will be to establish the ♠ suit.

So you next play ♠K, ♠A, then ruff a ♠ with dummy's ♥Q. East does not follow to the third ♠.

Next play ♦A and get to your hand by ruffing a ♦. Pull the last trump, then give up a ♠ to West. Win his return, (by ruffing if necessary) and take your established ♠ winner and dummy's ♣K.

Suppose you had considered taking the ♦ finesse. It would have done you no good at all.

If it worked, all you could do would be to discard your fifth ♠; but that was the ♠ that turned out to be a winner!

It was the fourth ♠ that was a loser, and you couldn't get rid of that one.

Partner's bid is a transfer asking you to bid 2♠, so you do. Partner now bids 3♥;

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Partner is showing 5-5 in the Majors, with at least invitational strength. It's a close thing, but you decide to accept the invitation and bid 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by South.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♣J. You play the ♣Q. West wins with the ♣A and plays the ♥A then the ♥3.

Loser List: ♠ = 1/2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 3/4

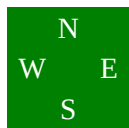
**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 9 6 4  
♥ 8 7 6 2  
♦ K 7 5  
♣ K 6

♠ Q 8 3 2  
♥ K Q 10  
♦ 10 8 3  
♣ Q 7 5



♠ K 5  
♥ A 9 4 3  
♦ A 6 4  
♣ A 9 8 2

♠ J 10 7  
♥ J 5  
♦ Q J 9 2  
♣ J 10 4 3

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
| 2♣   | Pass  | 1NT  | Pass  |
| 4♥   | Pass  | 2♥   | Pass  |

All Pass

4♥ by East

cannot make it), and also assumes you will be able to cross-ruff 4 small black cards.

With 10 points and two 4-card Majors you bid 2♣ Stayman. Partner says 2♥;

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Now you add a point for your doubleton, get to 11 points, and bid 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by West.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♦Q. Win the ♦Q in either hand. Lets say you win with your ♦A.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2\* : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 3\*

\*Don't get overconfident with this loser list. It assumes that trumps break 3-2, (if they don't you

Cross-ruffing those 4 losers could be a problem. You can't afford to get over-ruffed so it would be nice if you could pull some trumps before you start the cross-ruff. But you must make sure that only two rounds of trumps get pulled, otherwise you won't have the trumps for the cross-ruff.

It is actually simple to make sure exactly two rounds of trumps are drawn. At trick 2 just duck a ♥ in each hand. An opponent will win this, but you can take the next trick, (probably a ♦), and then pull a second round of trumps with your ♥A. Then leave the trumps alone and play your two black A K's, then start cross-ruffing with your 4 tiny trumps. The defender with the master trump can over-ruff when he can, and can even cash a ♦. But that's all he can do so you will make your game.

Suppose you had played first the ♥A, then a small ♥.

North would have won the second one, and if he had then continued ♦s you would have made the contract.

But if he was a good enough defender to pull a THIRD round of trumps, getting 2 for the price of 1 value, you would have been defeated.